DAY 6

Finding God in the Quiet



"After the wind, earthquake, and fire, Elijah perceives a gentle manifestation and stands before the Lord."

1 KINGS 19:11–13

There is almost always sound nearby. Your phone announces messages, a screen fills the pause, and even the shortest journey comes with music or commentary. None of that is necessarily wrong. But when every interval must be filled, it becomes hard to notice what is happening within us. Silence begins to feel uncomfortable because it brings up feelings that busyness has kept out of sight.

In Elijah's experience, the loudest events were not where he recognized the Lord's manifestation. Something gentle followed them. The passage does not establish that God reveals Himself only in silence, but challenges the expectation that His presence must arrive with intensity. The encounter may require attention to what could easily be overlooked.

That matters in everyday life. You may expect extraordinary emotion before considering time with God meaningful. When a reading ends without tears or excitement, it feels as though nothing happened. Yet understanding a sentence more carefully, recognizing an uneasiness, or giving a few attentive minutes can contribute to faith's maturity. Not every encounter produces a powerful feeling.

Quiet also allows you to notice your weariness. What we call spiritual distance is sometimes connected to a routine without rest, where we can barely listen to another person. Elijah reached that point after fear and exhaustion; his story includes food and rest. You need not disregard your body's needs to seek God. Attention can begin as you receive the care you need.

A brief pause can make room. It may be before leaving home, after a task, or when the family is asleep. You do not need to banish every thought to deserve that time. When you notice your mind wandering, gently return to the passage you read or the prayer you began. Making silence another test of performance would only add noise.

Remember also that not every thought arising in that pause should be taken as a message from God. Discernment requires time, consistency with Scripture, and willingness to seek guidance. A serene moment does not make every decision right. Quiet can help you examine motives and recognize questions without dispensing with prudence or turning every impression into certainty.

Today, allow a few minutes with fewer distractions. You may discover concerns to bring to prayer or gratitude you have overlooked. You may find only stillness. Receive the time without demanding an event. Drawing near to God also means being available, attentive enough to notice the care, truth, and responsibility that haste tends to conceal.

TO KEEP IN YOUR HEART

God's presence needs neither noise nor extraordinary emotion to be welcomed.

TODAY'S PRAYER

Lord, my attention is often divided among many voices and commitments. Help me create pauses in which I can be calmly before You. May I recognize my body's weariness and the concerns I hide in busyness. Teach me to listen without searching for signs in every thought, and to discern humbly. Receive this simple time, even if I feel nothing extraordinary. May stillness help me live with greater attention, honesty, and availability. Amen.